BATAVIA HIGH SCHOOL · FIELD EXPERIENCE · FOR WORKPLACE SUPERVISORS

Hosting an Intern: First Days & Final Days

New to hosting a high school intern? You don't need a formal training program. This checklist covers the few things that make the first two days go smoothly and the last two weeks end well. Check things off as you go.

Questions anytime: Michael Theriault · michael.theriault@bps101.net | Austun Savitski · austun.savitski@bps101.net

Already have a system for interns? If your onboarding already checks these boxes, great. Keep doing what works. This list is meant for new placements, or for anyone who isn't sure what the first days and final weeks should look like.

BEFORE DAY 1

Get ready

About 15 minutes, the week before they start.

- [ ] **Training Agreement is signed.** Student, parent, you, and the school all sign before the first day. No signatures, no start.
- [ ] **Confirm the schedule:** start date, which days, arrival and leave times.
- [ ] **Send the basics:** where to park, which door, who to ask for, what to wear.
- [ ] **Tell your team** an intern is coming, and name a backup contact for days you're out.
- [ ] **Plan 2–3 starter tasks** they can actually finish. Real work beats a stack of reading.
- [ ] **Check the tasks are allowed.** Interns are 16–18; child labor laws limit hazardous equipment and tasks. When in doubt, ask us.

DAY 1

Welcome & orientation

Goal: they leave knowing the rules and having done one real thing.

- [ ] **Meet them at the door** and give a quick tour: restrooms, break area, where to put their things.
- [ ] **Introduce the team** and say who to go to for what.
- [ ] **Cover safety:** exits, emergency steps, any protective gear, and what they should *not* touch or do.
- [ ] **Go over the rules:** phone use, breaks, dress, confidentiality, and how to call in if they'll be absent.
- [ ] **Handle setup:** badge, logins, keys, any paperwork.
- [ ] **Give one real task** with a clear finish line. Shadowing is fine, but end the day with something they did.
- [ ] **5-minute check-out:** What went well? Questions? What's the plan for next time?

DAY 2

Find a rhythm

Goal: they know what they own and how to ask for help.

- [ ] **Quick recap** of Day 1 and answer any questions they thought of overnight.
- [ ] **Give them a recurring job** they own each visit, so they can walk in and start.
- [ ] **Set 1–2 goals together.** They'll bring goals from class; help shape them to your workplace.
- [ ] **Explain what to do when they finish a task** or get stuck, and who to ask if you're busy.
- [ ] **Talk about photos.** Students build a portfolio. Tell them what they may photograph or save and what is confidential.
- [ ] **Check out again** for a few minutes. Give one piece of honest feedback.

DURING THE SEMESTER

What we'll ask of you

- [ ] **Verify hours.** Students need at least 60 and log them themselves; you confirm they're real.
- [ ] **Two short evaluations** (midterm in October, final in December) on the 10 employability skills, by Google Form. They count toward the student's grade.
- [ ] **A site visit** from one of us, with a few minutes of your time.
- [ ] **Keep feedback in the moment.** A quick "here's how we do it" beats saving it all for the evaluation.

> **Call or email us right away** about attendance, conduct, or safety concerns. You never need to handle a problem alone, and the student also reports absences to us.

FINAL 2 WEEKS

Wrap it up well

Goal: the student leaves with feedback, evidence of their work, and a good ending.

- [ ] **Complete the final evaluation** when the form arrives.
- [ ] **Approve portfolio items.** Help them pick photos or work samples they can show at the Capstone, with nothing confidential.
- [ ] **Have an exit conversation:** their strengths, one thing to keep working on, and your honest career advice.
- [ ] **Offer a reference** or LinkedIn recommendation if they earned it.
- [ ] **Collect badges, keys, and logins,** and confirm final hours.
- [ ] **Come to the Capstone Breakfast,** Tuesday, Dec 15, 8–10 AM. Hearing their Spotlight talk is the best part.
- [ ] **Thank your team** for helping the intern along.
- [ ] **Tell us how it went** and whether you'd host again.

The biggest thing: interns do best when someone checks in for a few minutes each visit, especially in the first two weeks. A short "how's it going?" prevents most problems before they start.